

interviews of customers, competitors, and suppliers. It wasn't as powerful by far as doing it your-self on a single stock, but it let us cover lots of ground. Today, we have replaced that with subsequent capital-markets technology; but that is, again, another story and outside the scope of this book.

Today my firm is managing many, many billions of dollars aimed at a handful of different goals while buying stocks around the globe and using 500-plus employees. You probably aren't doing that. You therefore shouldn't do what I'm doing, and I shouldn't do what you need to do. If you're an individual, all of the fifteen points still apply. Tactically, you use them the way I did as a young man when I didn't have the machine I have today. And you can't cover the turf I now can, but that probably isn't necessary or even desirable to you. My point is that the fifteen points are worthwhile whether used exactly as my father originally envisioned them or on an altered, more superficial but more mass-spectrum basis, for domestic or foreign stocks, for growth or value, or, for that matter, if you move away from public stocks to buy private busi-nesses, many or just that one that you might want to own and operate personally, no matter how small. All of the same principles apply.